

FORKLIFT LOADING AND UNLOADING TOOLBOX TALK

Loading areas combine forklift, vehicle and pedestrian movement in one high-risk zone.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Prevent overturning, dropped loads, vehicle movement and pedestrian impact during forklift loading and unloading.

KEY HAZARDS

1  Forklift overturning.	2  Loads falling from forks.	3  Truck or trailer movement.	4  Dock plate movement.
5  Pedestrian collision.	6  Loads blocking visibility.	7  Overloaded or unstable loads.	8  Wet or damaged loading surfaces.

CRITICAL POINTS TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

01 Forklift overturning.	02 Loads falling from forks.	03 Truck or trailer movement.
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REMEMBER — SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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FIELD REQUIREMENTS AND VERIFICATION

Prevent overturning, dropped loads, vehicle movement and pedestrian impact during forklift loading and unloading.

SERNEM FIELD 01
FIELD VERIFICATION 1
Forklift capacity suitable

SERNEM FIELD 02
FIELD VERIFICATION 2
Load stable

SERNEM FIELD 03
FIELD VERIFICATION 3
Vehicle secured

SERNEM FIELD 04
FIELD VERIFICATION 4
Wheel chocks installed

VERIFICATION BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Forklift capacity suitable | ☐ Load stable |
| ☐ Vehicle secured | ☐ Wheel chocks installed |
| ☐ Dock plate suitable | ☐ Pedestrian routes separated |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Is the load within forklift capacity?
- Is the vehicle secured?
- Is the dock plate suitable?

FIELD APPLICATION



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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES

1. ELIMINATE / REDUCE THE RISK

Verify load weight against forklift capacity. • Separate pedestrian and forklift routes. • Confirm loading surfaces are clean and structurally sound.

2. ENGINEERING & PHYSICAL CONTROLS

Position the load centre correctly on the forks. • Use reverse travel or a spotter when visibility is restricted. • Ensure drivers understand not to move until loading is formally complete.

3. WORK METHOD & FIELD CONTROLS

Secure trucks or trailers with wheel chocks or approved systems. • Keep forks as low as practical during travel.

4. PPE, VERIFICATION & SUPERVISION

Check dock-plate capacity. • Avoid sudden turns on ramps.

CRITICAL WARNING



Team, loading safety depends on controlling both the forklift and the vehicle. If the truck or trailer is not secured, loading will not begin.

SITE CHECKLIST — BEFORE STARTING WORK

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Forklift capacity suitable | ☐ Load stable |
| ☐ Vehicle secured | ☐ Wheel chocks installed |
| ☐ Dock plate suitable | ☐ Pedestrian routes separated |
| ☐ Visibility adequate | ☐ Surface sound |
| ☐ Driver briefed | ☐ Crew briefed |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
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